Of Lands Proposal

This document is meant to be somehow a redo to Of Lands Megadoc to encompass Of Land's reduced scope and make it less of a brainstorm blabber, but a more concrete vision on game mechanics. Whatever is not settled, will be a matter of discussion instead.

Design principles

While developing, setting principles/general guidelines on the work to be done was always something useful for general workflow. Therefore Of Lands has the following:

- Game is seen and directed through lens of settlements - they establish what is seen as player's state and are focal point of any other management
- Resources are local, meaning other mechanics adhere to this trait

Example of those principles in practice:

- Settlements are places where you hire settlers, workers and army, meaning you can't do anything without operating it with connection to settlement in some way
- If you create a mine somewhere, it will need a worker to deliver mined resources to the nearest town/village before they can be utilised - but wherever they are delivered, they can't be used anywhere else unless transported further

Workflow principles

Similarly to design principles above, I'd like to establish some workflow ones, so the work is not stalled as it happened with my other game, IoA, and neither is overscoping itself to eternity as it happened with NRoD and plenty other titles.

- two major words: **small scope** and **rapid pace**
- 1.0 should have minimal amount of enjoyable features, it can skip even major things such as trade or combat
- releases should be small, focused on particular feature, rarely multiple ones - it creates shorter timespans between each release, thus making iteration faster and pipeline more motivating
- there should be very specific goal of 1.0 specified, with also limited amount of post-1.0 features - which will set Of Lands in a very concrete direction and limit feeling of overwhelmingness
- any feature that feels like a stretch should be cut *entirely*, alternatively only put in old doc in case you wouldn't like to lose it - stating any goals in this doc should be doable in few months of development; reason for it is that every small goal even will eventually add to the psychical burden, and at certain burden level, it will be an obstacle for effective development

Map



Of Lands' map is made out of square tiles (unlike the reference above), each of which will have its data, such as type of terrain (e.g. lowlands, hills, mountains), features built by player or computer (e.g. village, road, mine, farm) and probably some other unique data. Depending on complexity, resources found on tile will be customized or based on type of terrain alone.
If this succeeds, creating maps will be done through Tiled.

Turn-based?

Most likely, yes. Not set in stone just yet, but all features made so far work upon this concept.

State

By state we mean all settlements and locations the player has control of. By itself state is more of an abstract idea, since principle #2 goes against overarching control of the state - instead, it is micromanaged through settlements.

Settlements are base building blocks of a state. Each settlement has its own character and interest, which depending on the area where it is built will differ.
Settlement is treated as a micro-state: it requires its needs fulfilled and be expanded to level up. Each settlement's existence and loss matters economically and on reign level.

From settlements you can hire entities that will help you build its power, and eventually expand to more settlements. The defeat of the empire is losing all its settlements.

Settlements

Settlement means an entity that is different from locations that it is a hub of management. The starting point of settlement is a **village** that is the smallest variant of it. Through various means, it can be later expanded to the rank of **town**, next to **city**, and later to **polis**. If you hire a settler to establish a new settlement, it will create a village first.

Upgrading settlement ranks is a more symbolic visualisation of their importance improving. It will come naturally through upgrading settlement important aspects, such as:

- fortificating it
- making it trade hub
- improving living standards
- etc.

Meaning that while singular upgrade to fortification for example won't upgrade it alone, building a palisade *and* market will turn it

into town however - the requirements of certain milestones will rise with each rank, but the outcomes will be felt immediately through more actions available through said settlement (palisade will help defending it from enemies for longer, market will allow for passive income and/or getting resources in and out more easily, etc.). Obviously higher ranked settlement means also bigger costs of maintaining it, so each upgrade will come with a risk.

Settlements may merge in the future, but this should not come with too big of a bonus to avoid cheesing this mechanic.

Locations

Outside of settlements, there will be a concept of locations that can be built by settlement's workers. Those will be either utility locations (such as **mine**, **farm**, **inn** etc.) or military ones (such as **outposts**, **forts** and so on).

Locations help settlements to grow economically and expand their influences - mines and farms allow to deliver more resources to the settlement, making it possible for them to expand (specifically because some resources can't be produced in the settlement itself).

Transport pipeline

Existence of locations however impose a challenge that is transporting resources from one place to the other - due to principle #2, the resources won't teleport themselves to the settlement the location belongs to, but will need workers to deliver them.
This means managing the pipeline of excavation-transport is crucial for effective gameplay and also highlights the core aspect of Of Lands' relationships between every point of interest.

Initially, a resource gathering location will try to make workers travel from itself to the settlement the location belongs to. That

said however, workers delivering it by foot (assuming they use a barrow at least) through rough terrain is very ineffective.
The first step to improve that would be to build a road between location and settlement, which speeds up the worker. This is the most economically viable solution to locations relatively close to the settlement itself.

Another way to handle this, and particularly useful with locations further away, would be to create a smaller settlement just near the location - a “mining village” or “farming village” that would get the resources right from the location located a tile near to it.
Then, to make the original settlement actually get the resources instead of the village, the player would set up the carriage transport that would cycle between settlements with much greater speed.
This way of automation would be also crucial for a later trade system (between settlements within a player state, but also for trading with computer-ruled settlements (these ones however through trade agreement)).

Environment

I imagine environment would play a crucial role in making principle #2 so important, yet enhancing gameplay. If the settlement is located in a particular environment, it can work with its resources, but is limited to them - it can technically send workers for far areas, but then the time of transport can become absurdly long. This intuitively forces the player to expand their area to new settlements, creating a chain - but, as I imagine, each subsequent settlement would also profit the original one by becoming of higher rank - for example by ensuring the long transports are safer, by letting armies rest/refill resources, or speeding up resource exchange (or rerouting them - for example through water route if land would not be traversable).

This will build a complex relationships of settlements each needing each other, and setting up routes and location web an engaging part of the gameplay.

Environmental storytelling

You may be able to find some ambient locations around the world, such as **fort ruins**, **shipwrecks** and so on. Those are meant to be interactable by the same rules as they are replicable - they may have happened before you (and be part of the map) but they had a reason to appear.
Therefore, your fort can turn into ruin - by being successfully invaded. Your ship can sink, and turn into a shipwreck.
But similarly as these will exist in the world and will inevitably get more frequent as you play, you will be able to also use them - ruined forts will be able to be rebuilt. Shipwreck may yield you some useful resources. A destroyed bridge could be repaired. And so on, and so on.
Note: I also think ruined forts should be able to let you camp in there and provide a bit better protection. But they should not be a good way for long-term establishment of power over the area, lacking basic features (e.g. recruitment).

Seasons

Seasons is currently an experimental feature that may be cut at any moment - however, the implications of increased difficulty and a strive to survival they create is too big of a tease not to write that idea down.

First of all, the seasonal system would enhance the atmosphere *a lot*. The sheer fact of visual passing of time, being able to see the grass be covered with snow, would be fantastic to make the game more cosy, yet also visually interesting.

Technically it could be made either by providing unique tiles, or tinting with colour. The first ensures more custom character, while the other makes it faster.

But, the core point of seasons is that they would be yet another determinant of resources and how people live in various environments. It would also make a natural motivation for settlements to expand and get richer, especially in the beginning.

Basically, seasons would dictate when the harvest is done (potentially making harvested food a more scarce resource), potentially also an increased usage of food (coal too?) during winter as an increased need.
Areas devoid of food would have a hard time surviving, so a good pipeline should be established for them to survive. This would give a reason to care about mining villages located high in the mountains, as not only the transport itself there would be difficult (many tiles of <1.0 travel speed) but it would also have the smallest ability to provide food for itself from local areas.

The same goes for things like traversal speed - during winter the speed of travel would decrease. If there was a way to make weather (which is probably way too far of a detail) areas where it is raining could also have such an effect.

Routes & trade

As mentioned earlier, players would have free ability to set up routes of various uses. Carriages transporting resources between settlements, armies patrolling and so on. Route setup would mean Of Lands can be - especially later in the game - quite heavily automated. It will also make the world feel more alive, as we would see entities roam all over the place.
Players would be given an editor and decide what path the selected entity would take, and whether the route is meant to be done once

or regularly. They could also customize when and how much resources carriages would take.

This system also enables what could be considered a trade - between towns of one faction (e.g. you can set up your own settlements exchanging resources they have more of) or between various parties (e.g. player and computer). The trade will be done by setting up a route and specifying details on what products, how much and when should be taken out - and the same for taking them in from the second place.
In terms of trading with other players though, the player would need trade agreement.

Diplomacy

Trade agreements - as other diplomacy aspects - would be forged through diplomacy. Albeit it is meant to be fairly simplistic, it would involve all basic necessities you'd imagine when talking about it.
The feature however is not fully brainstormed.

Few thoughts: it would be nice that 1) getting negative relationship with kingdom doesn't result in war (e.g. if you have bigger power than them, they can take much more insults/issues with you); 2) trade and war agreements could be separate thing, so you could have war agreements that either are set normally or by the fact of someone being your vassal (see stretch features).

Army

Players could recruit an army in settlements or forts. The army however, is in a way a mobile settlement - it has needs! Most particularly a food one. While stationed in the settlement, the army will contribute to its food spending, although lessening its regular use. In wilderness however, the army will require an additional carriage (or few) to carry the food, which will slow them down, but

is the only way to allow longer campaigns without starving them to death or desertion.

Army can station in settlements, forts and outposts, making areas around safer and alert of any enemy encounters early, possibly reacting to it automatically.

Combat

While combat is a big unknown for now, it is conceptualised as a card game. It may become something simpler however, depending on other factors adding to how fast development happens.

Moddability & other technicals

In general, limited scope of the game means I do not plan on supporting modding broadly. It would be cool to have map editor as a separate app/within the game, maybe allow for more terrain being added or more cultures to exist, but alas. This is for EoE to have most likely.

One thing however that I want to include is the ability to make various maps through Tiled (or other means) and them being chooseable before starting gameplay. It is a bit more low-level support of modding, but one that is nice to have nevertheless.

Cultures & lore

Despite early plans to be very Baedoor-driven, I think it will be more optimal to either make this game culture monolithic (could work for latoka lorebuilding I imagine) or even devoid of connections to lore entirely. The point is that player and computer should *not* have different cultures nor mechanics adjusting to them - this is a very easy way to explode the scope dramatically, and for little gain with a game that is not planned to have such focus on lore. This one should be saved for EoE, simply as.

To be expanded (DO NOT add more, this is full scope)

- Types of settlement expansions and how they contribute to rank upgrades
- Resource list and locations/ways to get them
- State boundaries and how they matter
- Military
    - effect of forts and guardtowers on state boundaries and/or nearby locations and paths
    - recruitment and stationing in locations?

Other notes

- Settlement getting palisade/wall changing its look despite not changing its rank would be cool, similarly with carriages/workers being visibly seen travelling from one place to the other
- Similarly, I imagine transport/travel/trade routes would need to have some kind of “path editor” and be editable later
- Also cities should be able to expand to multiple tiles imo 👉👈
- It would be good to make a list of features cut, in case someone would like to mod it later or if I decided this game is too superb to exist without updates

Resource List

Note: if we go by idea of attributes, we can avoid some types by simply directing them through attrs alone. E.g. instead of coal being "fuel" (with wood being fuel, but not only), we could make coal "misc" and just give both coal and wood attribute of fuel=n (with n being higher for coal)
Also: if we make entities take *resources* as consumable, but not defaulting it to food, you could make fuel to be consumable, allowing vehicles to be used (or, in the case of horses, make wheat as consumable?)

Name	Produced by	Use
Legend: • **Location** • **Settlement building** • **Resource used** • **Terrain type** ○ **Terrain property** • **^ – tiered** • **PTR – specific to Elder Scrolls map**		
Coin	**Mint** (**gold**), **inn**, **market**, **settlements**, **trade**, **other**	• Used broadly for payments (citizens/army), trade • Symbolises wealth of settlement and incentive for guilds/banks to be set
Building resources		
Wood	**Sawmill** (**forest**)	Sawmill gets n/2-r amount of wood each turn where *n* is forest tiles count in range of square 2 and *r* is number of sawmills in this square • Base building block to any structures • Can be used as a less efficient fuel in settlements

Stone	Quarry	• Base building block to any structures
Clay	Aggregate Pit (non-desert)	• Base building block to any structures
Bricks	Kiln (clay)	• Building block to more advanced structures • Required for upgrade from town to city
Glass	Aggregate Pit (desert)	• Building block to most advanced structures • Required for upgrade from city to polis
Minerals and ores		
Coal	Mine (mountains/coal deposit)	• Can be used as more efficient fuel in settlements
Iron	Mine (mountains/iron deposit)	• Used to produce tools, weapons, regular jewelry and higher class furniture
Gold	Mine (mountains/gold deposit)	• Used as trade good and resource to produce coins and rich jewelry
Copper	Mine (mountains/copper deposit)	• Used to produce higher class tableware and regular jewelry
Silver	Mine (mountains/silver deposit)	• Used as trade good and to produce rich jewelry • Used to produce silver weapons[PTR]
Adamantium[PTR]	Mine (mountains/adamantium deposit)	
Glass[PTR]	Mine (glass deposit)	• Used to produce glass weapons and armours
Ebony[PTR]	Mine (ebony deposit)	• Used to produce ebony weapons, armours and tableware
Orichalcum	Mine	• Used to produce orichalcum weapons and armours

PTR	(**mountains**/orichalcum deposit)	
Bitterstone[P] TR	**Mine** (bitterstone deposit)	
Food Used primarily to supply settlements, some locations and entities during their travel. More variety improves settlements - variety of types improve health, variety of type variants (e.g. cod and salmon) improve morale.		
Meat	**Hunting Lodge, Animal Farm** (**wheat**)	• One of base foods, giving bigger bonus to settlement food fill • Required for upgrade from town to city
Fish	**Fishing Quay** (**water-adjecent tile**)	• One of base foods, giving bigger bonus to settlement food fill
Wheat		• Used for production of bread • Consumed by horses and used by animal farms
Bread		• One of base foods, giving bigger bonus to settlement food fill
Fruits		• One of base foods, giving bigger bonus to settlement food fill
Vegetables		• One of base foods, giving bigger bonus to settlement food fill
Mushrooms		• One of secondary foods, giving medium bonus to settlement food fill
Cheese?		• One of secondary foods, giving medium bonus to settlement food fill
Rice		• One of base foods, giving bigger bonus to settlement food fill

Olives		
Algae?		• One of secondary foods, giving medium bonus to settlement food fill • Can be used as less efficient fuel in settlements
Kwama Eggs[PTR]		• One of base foods, giving bigger bonus to settlement food fill
Salt		• Decreases food usage in winter • Improves morale of settlement • Has a bigger food saving effect than spices, but lesser in morale
Sugar		• Decreases food usage in summer • Improves morale of settlement • Has a bigger food saving effect than spices, but lesser in morale
Spices		• Decreases food usage (across the whole year) • Improves morale of settlement • Has a lesser food saving effect than salt/sugar, but bigger in morale
Beer		• Improves morale of settlement, decreasing efficiency
Wine		• Improves wealth status of settlement, decreasing efficiency
Tea		• Improves wealth status of settlement, without penalty
Coffee		• Improves wealth status of settlement, improving efficiency

Milk?		
Middle-of-process goods		
Wool	**Animal Farm** (**wheat**)	• One of possible resources to produce clothing
Fur	**Hunting Lodge**	• One of possible resources to produce clothing
Flax	**Plantation** (flax)	**Fiber:** • Required for ship construction • One of possible resources to produce paper and clothing
Cotton	**Plantation** (cotton)	**Fiber:** • Required for ship construction • One of possible resources to produce paper and clothing
Silk	**Plantation** (silk)	• Used to produce fine clothing
Flowers?	**Herbalist Lodge**	• Used to produce dye and spices
Dye?		• Used to produce fine clothing
Paper	**Paper Mill** (wood/flax/cotton)	• Used to produce books • Improves the research status of the city
Gems		
Amber		
Ivory		
Jade		
Settlement needs		
Furniture^: Regular Middle Rich	**Carpenter House** (**wood**) **Carpenter House** (**wood, iron**)	• Used by settlements • Improve comfort level • Lack of any furniture decreases morale • Middle level is required for upgrade from town to city

	Carpenter House (**wood, gold/silver/ivory**)	• Rich level improves wealth of the city, incentivising guilds and banks
Tableware^: Regular Middle Rich	**Kiln** (clay) / **Carpenter House** (wood) **Kiln** (clay, coal) / **Forge** (iron/copper) **Kiln** (clay, coal, dye) / **Forge** (gold/silver/glass metal[PTR]/ebony[PTR]/jade[PTR])	• Used by settlements • Improve comfort level • Lack of any tableware decreases morale • Middle level is required for upgrade from town to city • Rich level improves wealth status of the city, incentivising guilds and banks
Clothing^: Regular Fine	**Weaver House** (wood/fur/flax/cotton) **Weaver House** (silk, dye)	• Used by settlements • Improve comfort level • Lack of any clothing decreases morale and warmth level • Regular level is required for upgrade from village to town • Fine level is required for upgrade from city to polis • Fine level improves wealth status of the city
Jewelry^: Regular Rich	**Forge** (copper/iron) **Forge** (gems/amber, gold/silver/jade)	• Used by settlements • Improve wealth status and morale • Required for upgrade from city to polis
Tools	**Forge** (iron/copper)	• Used by settlement and some buildings
Herbs	**Herbalist Lodge**	• Used by apothecary building to be distributed in nearest settlement tiles, improving their health • Used to produce spices
Books	**Printing House** (paper)	• Used by school and universities to improve education and research levels • Required for banks to be set up • Used by banks after being set up

Wax	**Beehive**	• Used by settlement, improves comfort level
Combat		
Weapons		
Armour		

Location List

Name	Use
Services	
Inn	Earns income - amount of which depends on road connected and amount of settlements the road connects with. It also requires food, but can replenish food of entities wandering through its tile.
Production	
Sawmill	Produces wood.
Quarry	Produces stone.
Mine	Exploits ore deposit that this tile contains.
Aggregate Pit	Produces clay (on non-desert tiles) or glass (on desert tiles).
Hunting Lodge	Produces meat and fur.
Animal Farm	Produces meat and wool, consuming wheat.
Plantation	Produces flax, cotton or silk, depending on resources available on tile.
Herbalist Lodge	Gathers plants or flowers.
Beehive	Produces wax.
Military	
Outpost	Provides protection in nearby tiles and a bit broader across roads, if there's an entity

	stationed there.
Fortress	Provides protection similarly to the outpost, but also allows for recruiting new soldiers (allowing for that outside of settlement).

Settlement Buildings List

Name	Use
Walls	Used for protection. Can be wooden or stone
Warehouse	Allows for storing more resources? (this would mean each settlement tile has limits, but it would make also a lot of sense I guess) ***Note:*** *maybe the limit would not be towards the* ***amount*** *of resources, but resource* ***types****? (as unintuitive as it may be)*
Services	
Tavern	Fills the housing need for the tile and generates annual money (less than inn), consuming food in return. **Probably should have some other advantage?**
Hotel	Fills the housing need of all nearby tiles
Market	Earns annual money and allows for trading in between settlements
Temple	Needed to keep settlement spiritual needs satisfied
Apothecary	Distributes herbs in nearby settlement tiles
Resource processing	
Fishing Quay	Produces fish; needs to be on water-adjecent tile
Kiln	Needed for brick and tableware production
Forge	Needed for production of all metal-based resources (tools, weapons, armour, jewelry, tableware)

Carpenter House	Needed for furniture production
Weaver House	Needed for clothing production
Paper Mill	Used to process resources into paper
Printing House	Needed for book production
Mint	Used to produce coins from gold
Military	
Barracks	Increase safety level and allow for producing military units

Settlement Needs

Name	Description	Achieved by
Food	The most important aspect, a necessity for settlement to survive.	• Food
Warmth	One of the most important aspects, as unmaintained it will set food needs much higher during winter.	• Fuels (wood/coal) • Clothing
Housing / space		
Comfort / luxury (wealth)		
Morale		Existence of various utility or luxury goods, no deficits in other needs (especially counted long-term)
Health		• Water sources nearby • Dedicated buildings (apothecary) • Variety of food
Safety		• Units in settlement • Dedicated buildings (barracks) • Military reach (this protection feature gathered from fortresses/outposts on tiles)
Religion		• Dedicated buildings (temple)
Education		

Research		

Housing/space

If settlements become too crowded, it will lower both morale and health. A bit of "I'm not exactly sure what I mean" need, but one that pushes you to expand, yet also to build more things to maintain the population.
Achieved by: expanding the settlement, regulating population growth? (touches a lot migration/new settlements which may be a bit overscoped; and can put too much pressure for the game)

Comfort/luxury (wealth)

Not sure about it, since it kinda interoperates with morale, but basically the cosier/richer the settlement, the bigger feeling of comfort.
One way I see this useful for OL mechanically is that specific levels of this could enable banking or other "higher status" features.

Education

Provides better outcomes of certain tasks and makes citizens happier. *Probably should produce some additional value*.

Achieved by: dedicated buildings (school), books

Research

Raises the general reputation of the city as a center of culture and science. *Probably should produce some additional value*.

Achieved by: dedicated buildings (universities), paper, education value

Regular Entities

Settler

Constructs settlements (villages).

Builder

Constructs locations. Initially holds part of its cost in building materials, but to construct many locations it needs to resupply more of them in settlements/locations.
It can destroy locations, which adds some materials to his equipment.

Army Entities

More settlement types

Mostly to accommodate for some unique scenarios, but with the caveat of not being able to expand unless converted to standard settlement. My thought is that following could be added:

- **camp town** - small (most likely 1 tile?), buildable by more entities, but also with limited choice of "buildings" to be done (building should have "camp variant" to exist); an advantage of camp town would be that it could be moved, preserving the "buildings"
  Examples: khajiit camps, Malahk Orcs camps, Ayleid enclaves, etc.
- **fortress town** - from small to upper town size, it would be possible to expand fortress into fortress town; the settlement would have less building spots than usual town, and walls as requirement to exist (meaning even more slots taken); it would naturally offer bigger defence, however
  Examples: Indoril chapels, part of Soulrest taken by Kingdom of Black Marsh

More consequences from actions

Lus: *Ok sorry for scopecreep but what if areas could be deforested and turn into grasslands/heath/desert :owo~1:*

My thought: good and interesting idea. Actually there are two ways here to go through:

- deforestation as an outcome - it happens as a result of nearby woodcutters working
- deforestation as an action - just like rebuilding the ruined fort, you take action on terrain this time, and it is action performed with intent, terraforming it to other type

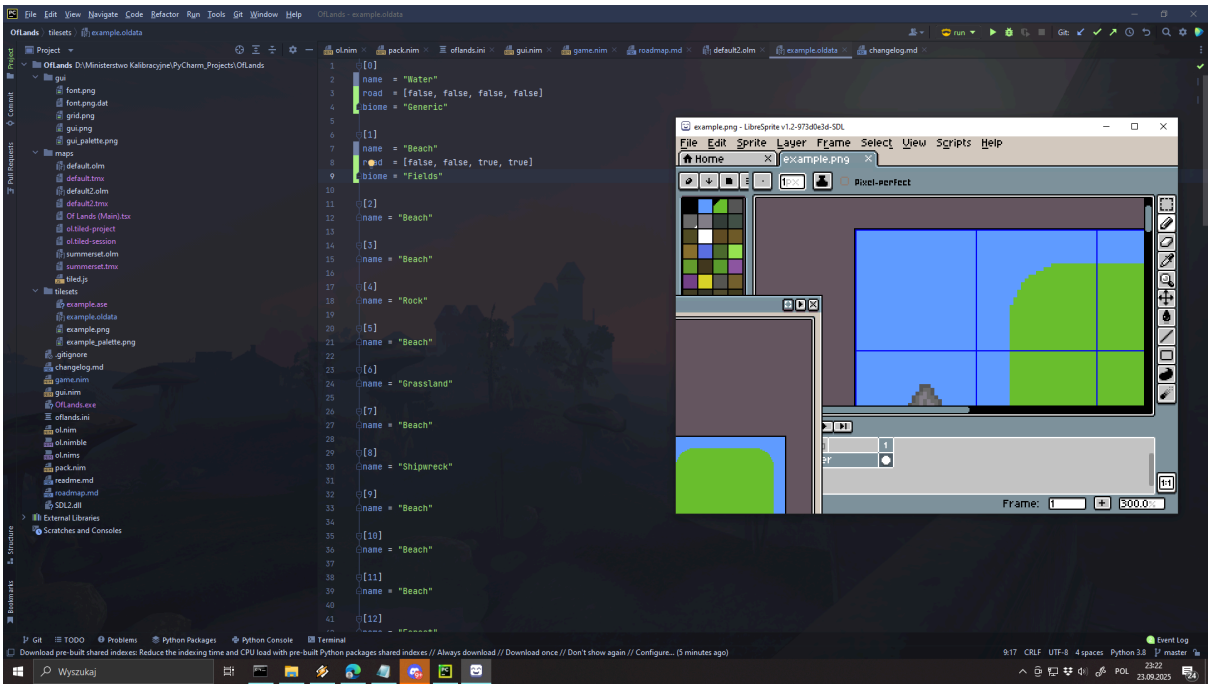
The second approach is much more workable, as it is a simple switch - it could be even part of .oldata format, where you could have key "deforestation" with index to tile that it'd swap to in such a case. This would probably need keeping its contents (roads,

locations) but if the location used forest tile, it would need to become defunct.

The "outcome" variant is harder, and this is why initially I was more against it.

Biomes

Biomes are a bit more of a support idea, as they would be needed if weather went in. That said, setting them up would be fairly easy, just make it an .oldata field with ID.



Weather

Weather is something that could affect traversal speed.

Day-night Cycle

Day-night cycle could be represented by houses having glowing windows. Mechanically, it could help attacking armies giving them some bonus - or, if there was something like "awareness" or "vision" for armies included, it could probably adjust that somehow.

Vassals & tributaries

Ability to make kingdoms either a part of a greater whole, lessening their independence, and independent kingdoms that could pay tributes.
This would add nuance to how politics operates and help make interesting/more accurate scenarios, e.g. for Tamriel map.

Establishing new kingdoms

Having your kingdom, it would be useful to be able to delegate some power to AI - it would happen through establishing a new kingdom that would become entirely subservient to you, but have their tasks automated. Ideally, you would be able to somehow direct its progress, but in a much less manual way than if you ruled over this area yourself.

Guilds

Semi-entities that could be either part of kingdom interest, or a separate entity. Use case unknown, but it could be useful for both enlarging economy/be end-game challenge, and PTR map.
In a similar way, we could have banks (either as guilds or a separate entity).

It may be good to also make the possibility of the faction being able to control the company fully (or fund new one!), which is how I'd solve Ra-Habi Company being both a guild and faction controlling Heldorn.

Cultures

Will showcase differences between factions more heavily (by different architecture/locations), but also be a shared aspect between them, probably adjusting relationships within this group.
A question whether *culture* and *race* should be separated concepts and how they'd affect gameplay is something to consider.

Also it could be expanded to be a more Civ-like system (e.g. a culture percentage within a city), but it'd make it an even more scope-creepy feature.

What is also valid is that culture could remain architecture-wise even after conquest. This way you could decide whether to nuke the settlement/location, rebuild in your style, or keep the way it is. In Tiled system I imagine it could be done like that:

- when building, you choose from your culture arc style
- when conquering, the arc style settlement initiated remains unless decided otherwise
- Tiled could have faction's culture and settlement's culture (set during building), with the latter taking priority; if not set on settlement metadata, faction culture would be used

Public transport

Entities that allow for carrying other entities (such as ships, airships, carriages) are able to have transport routes. It would work similarly to resource routes, but instead of carrying actual resources, it would do so with population*.
This would generate income, meaning that if you have idle entities of that type, they can be repurposed to earn money. Additionally, having public transport between settlements would improve citizens' morale.

* most likely with equal amounts being taken between point A and] B, as to not mess with settlements' count (albeit if these would not be equal, it could be fun to mirror some migration habits and make this system a bit more hazardous - it can be very much too complex to matter or have sense, though); **that said**, it would make sense that transported population could vanish if transport was attacked - this would add one more purpose for "guard structures" which would help mitigating such events.

Dryness

Tile data about how far is the closest tile that has "has_water" property true. If tile has water nearby, it is wetter, allowing for farming and health boost to settlement on it. If it is dry (no water in the near area), it makes surviving in this area more challenging.